Yimeng Wang

Ywang139@wm.edu
yimengyvonne.github.io
804-684-1349

Education

- **Ph.D. Candidate in Computer Science** 2024 – Present
  Qualifying Examination Passed, Jun 2025
  William & Mary, Williamsburg, VA, USA
- **Master of Science in Statistics** 2023
  University of Notre Dame, Notre Dame, IN, USA
- **Bachelor of Science in Information and Computing Science** 2021
  University of Science and Technology Beijing, Beijing, China
- **International Summer Undergraduate Research (Univ. of Notre Dame)** June 2020 – Aug 2020

Research Experience

Graduate Research Assistant, William & Mary HCI Lab 2024 - Present

- **Research focus**: Lead HCI research on **human-AI interaction** and trust dynamics, developing **contextual AI systems** across multiple studies.
- Developed and validated novel trust measurement scales using advanced statistical modeling, including factor analysis, Gaussian Mixture Models, clustering analysis, and power analysis, to analyze complex user behavior patterns and trust formation dynamics.
- Led algorithm/prototype development and theoretical framework creation for human-AI trust research, utilizing Python, PyTorch, LLMs, and multiple statistical packages (R, scikit-learn) to interpret trust dynamics across social media platforms and mental health applications.
- **Mentored** undergraduate research assistants, providing guidance on research designing, interface prototyping, and contributing to their co-authorship on peer-reviewed publications.
- Collaborated with **interdisciplinary teams** of engineers, designers, and researchers to advance HCI research, contributing novel theoretical frameworks for understanding trust-distrust coexistence in contextual AI interface design.
- Published research findings in **top-tier HCI venues** (CHI'24, CHI'25, CHI'26), demonstrating independent research leadership in user studies, experimental design, and human-AI research.

Graduate Research Intern, Northwestern University Sept 2023 - Dec 2023

- Developed CNN/LSTM-based models using Python and PyTorch to predict cardiovascular disease outcomes from longitudinal health data, achieving 90.87% accuracy.
- Designed and executed **experimental protocols** to evaluate multiple machine learning approaches, contributing to the development of predictive healthcare interface design.

Publication

- **Yimeng Wang**, Liabette Escamilla, Yinzhou Wang, Bianca R. Augustine, Yixuan Zhang. *Exploring Customizable Interactive Tools for Therapeutic Homework Support in Mental Health Counseling*. In Proceedings of the 2026 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI '26). https://doi.org/10.1145/3772318.3790569
- Wenhan Lyu, **Yimeng Wang**, Murong Yue, Yifan Sun, Jennifer Suh, Meredith Kier, Ziyu Yao, Yixuan Zhang. *Designing AI Peers for Collaborative Mathematical Problem Solving with Middle School Students: A Participatory Design Study*. In Proceedings of the 2026 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI '26). https://doi.org/10.1145/3772318.3791138
- Chen Qian, **Yimeng Wang**, Yu Chen, Lingfei Wu, Andreas Stathopoulos. *From "Thinking" to "Justifying": Aligning High-Stakes Explainability with Professional Communication Standards*. In Proceedings of the 64th Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL '26). https://doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.2601.07233
- **Yimeng Wang**, Yinzhou Wang, Alicia Hong, Yixuan Zhang. *Explore LLM-enabled Tools to Facilitate Imaginal Exposure Exercises for Social Anxiety*. In Proceedings of the 2026 ACM Conference on Interactive Health. https://doi.org/10.1145/3786579.3804922
- **Yimeng Wang**, Yinzhou Wang, Kelly Crace, Yixuan Zhang. *Understanding Attitudes and Trust of Generative AI Chatbots for Social Anxiety Support*. In Proceedings of the 2025 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI '25). Association for Computing Machinery, New York, NY, USA, Article 1123, 1–21. https://doi.org/10.1145/3706598.3714286
- Wenhan Lyu, **Yimeng Wang**, Yifan Sun, Yixuan Zhang. *Will Your Next Pair Programming Partner Be Human? An Empirical Evaluation of Generative AI as a Collaborative Teammate in a Semester-Long Classroom Setting*. In Proceedings of the Twelfth ACM Conference on Learning @ Scale (L@S '25). Association for Computing Machinery, New York, NY, USA, 83–94. https://doi.org/10.1145/3698205.3729544
- Yixuan Zhang*, **Yimeng Wang***, Nutchanon Yongsatianchot, Joseph D Gaggiano, Nurul M Suhaimi, Anne Okrah, Miso Kim, Jacqueline Griffin, Andrea G Parker. *Profiling the Dynamics of Trust & Distrust in Social Media: A Survey Study*. In Proceedings of the 2024 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI '24). Association for Computing Machinery, New York, NY, USA, Article 947, 1–24. https://doi.org/10.1145/3613904.3642927
- Wenhan Lyu, **Yimeng Wang**, Tingting (Rachel) Chung, Yifan Sun, Yixuan Zhang. *Evaluating the Effectiveness of LLMs in Introductory Computer Science Education: A Semester-Long Field Study*. In Proceedings of the Eleventh ACM Conference on Learning @ Scale (L@S '24). Association for Computing Machinery, New York, NY, USA, 63–74. https://doi.org/10.1145/3657604.3662036

Honors & Awards

- Graduate Travel Grants (from the W&M Department of Computer Science) 2025, 2026
- GSA Conference Award (**limited number of awards** from W&M Office of Graduate Studies and GSA) 2025
- Seed Grants (W&M Research Graduate Studies Advisory Board) 2024
- Third Prize in The Fifteenth National College Student Smart Car Competition 2020

- Merit Student (top 5% academic performance in USTB) 2018–2019
- People's Third-class Scholarship (top 5% academic performance in USTB) 2018–2019
- Excellent Student Leader (student org leadership in USTB) 2017–2018
- People's Second-class Scholarship (top 3.5% in USTB) 2017–2018

Professional Experience

Workshop

- Poster presentation in W&M Graduate Research Symposium. Feb 2025
- Poster presentation in W&M Computer Science Symposium for Graduate Studies. Nov 2024
- Poster presentation in Computing Research Association Grad Cohort Workshops (CRA-WP). Apr 2024

Teaching Experience

- ***Lecturer: Duties including preparing course materials, having lectures, holding office hours.***

  Scientific Computing with Python (FA23-ACMS-20220) Fall 2023

  Conducted weekly 50-minute tutorials, introduced diverse problem-solving approaches, and hosted Zoom office hours with recorded sessions for accessibility.

- ***Assistant: Duties including validating course materials, holding office hours, attending classes, and grading exams.***

  Data Structures (CSCI-241) Spring 2025
  Intro to HCI (CSCI-420/520) Fall 2024
  Data Structures (CSCI-241) Spring 2024
  Behavior Data Science (FA23-DS-60632) Fall 2023
  Linear Models (SP22-DS-64510) Spring 2022

Academic Service

Press Coverage

- The art of asking questions: Does AI in the classroom facilitate deep learning in students?
- Reducing distrust in social media is not straightforward, computer scientists warn.

Invited Talk

- Delivered a talk for CSCI 420/520 Course entitled “Quantitative Methods for HCI” at W&M Oct 2025
- Delivered a talk for CSCI 780 Course entitled “Quantitative Evaluation” at W&M Apr 2024

Academic Reviews

- Poster Track Associate Chairs (CHI LBW 2026)
- CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI 2026)
- ACM Conference on Computer-Supported Cooperative Work and Social Computing (CSCW 2026)
- International Journal of Human–Computer Interaction (HIHC 2025)
- ACM Transactions on Computing for Healthcare (HEALTH 2024, 2025)
- Human–Machine Communication (HMC 2025)
- SIGCHI Late Breaking Work (CHI LBW 2024, 2025)

Voluntary Experience

- Student Volunteer for the SIGCHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI2025)
  May 2025